



LINKEDIN

LinkedIn is another one of those social media giants that has taken the web world by storm. It provides an exclusive platform for users to interact with each other in a professional environment and showcase their achievements, talents and interests. As such it's an ideal forum for job seekers and head hunters. It also serves as a specialised profile building platform and enables users to



Connecting professionally is what it's all about

maintain multiple levels of connections. Off late there've been some amazing developments from LinkedIn giving users access to a multitude of features. This Tips & Tricks section is not a tutorial teaching you how to build a strong LinkedIn profile but it will guide you on how to harness LinkedIn's technical platform to get the best out of it. Follow these nifty tricks and cheats for mastering LinkedIn.



SEO your profile

The fact that you're a LinkedIn user means that you're out there to market yourself and your skills. As such you need to make your profile easier to find when searched for using a search engine. A useful tip is to include a certain keyword throughout your profile. Make sure that this keyword appears in your endorsements and recommendations as well. Once done, you can check and rate your profile against others with similar keyword by doing a search by people. This tip is hardly a LinkedIn



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specific hack but is extremely useful and powerful.



Use Boolean search

The LinkedIn search bar has awesome support for Boolean search, which means that you can execute complex searches by combining Boolean operators (terms such as AND, OR, NOT). For example, if you want to search for a software engineer or architect you can search for 'software AND Engineer OR Architect' by combining the AND and OR Boolean operators. For exact matches, use

quotation marks on either side of specific terms and use the NOT operator to exclude certain terms. E.g. "subject matter expert" NOT "technical writer". This sort of search query allowance lets you look for extremely specific profiles or a largely generalised database of profiles by a smart combination of Boolean operators.



Reorder and rearrange headers

Don't like the way your profile headers are arranged? Reorder them. Simply go to the Profile >

Edit Profile and move your mouse pointer to the double-sided arrow at the extreme right of each header. Click and drag to rearrange the positions of the headers.



Build your resume

LinkedIn has a really nice built-in Resume Builder tool which can turn your profile into a resume that you can print, store and share as a .pdf file. To export your LinkedIn profile as a resume, go to <http://resume.linkedinlabs.com/> and click on the "Create a new resume now" button. Grant access to the Resume Builder application. You'll then be redirected to a page where your resume will be exported to a document type sheet. You can choose between various resume formats. After zeroing in on the desired format and content, click on the PDF/print option located at the end of the menu just above the sample document to save and download the resume as a .pdf file.

You're probably already aware of a similar feature within your LinkedIn profile where you also have the option of a quick .pdf download of your profile. However, that's a plain Jane version compared to the template options you'll get with Resume Builder.



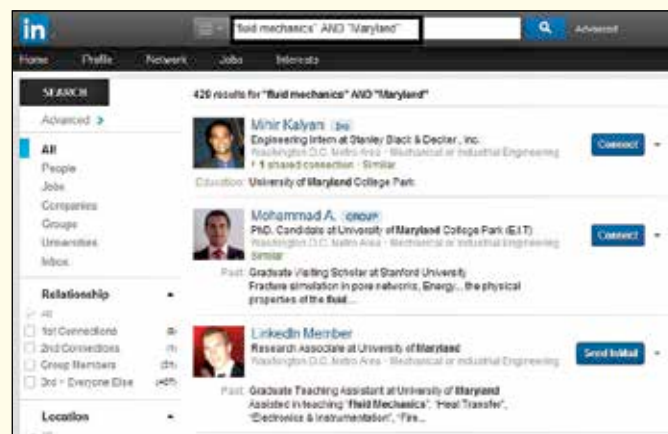
Export contacts

LinkedIn enables you to have multiple levels of connections. As such it gets really important to organise contacts. You can export LinkedIn contacts to another contact or people management system. To do this, go to Network > Contacts > My Connections. Then scroll down and click on the bottom right option of Export connections. There's an option to export contacts either as a .csv or .vcf file.



Remove Contacts tab

Deleting connections is not a really smooth procedure in



Optimise your profile to get pulled up in search results